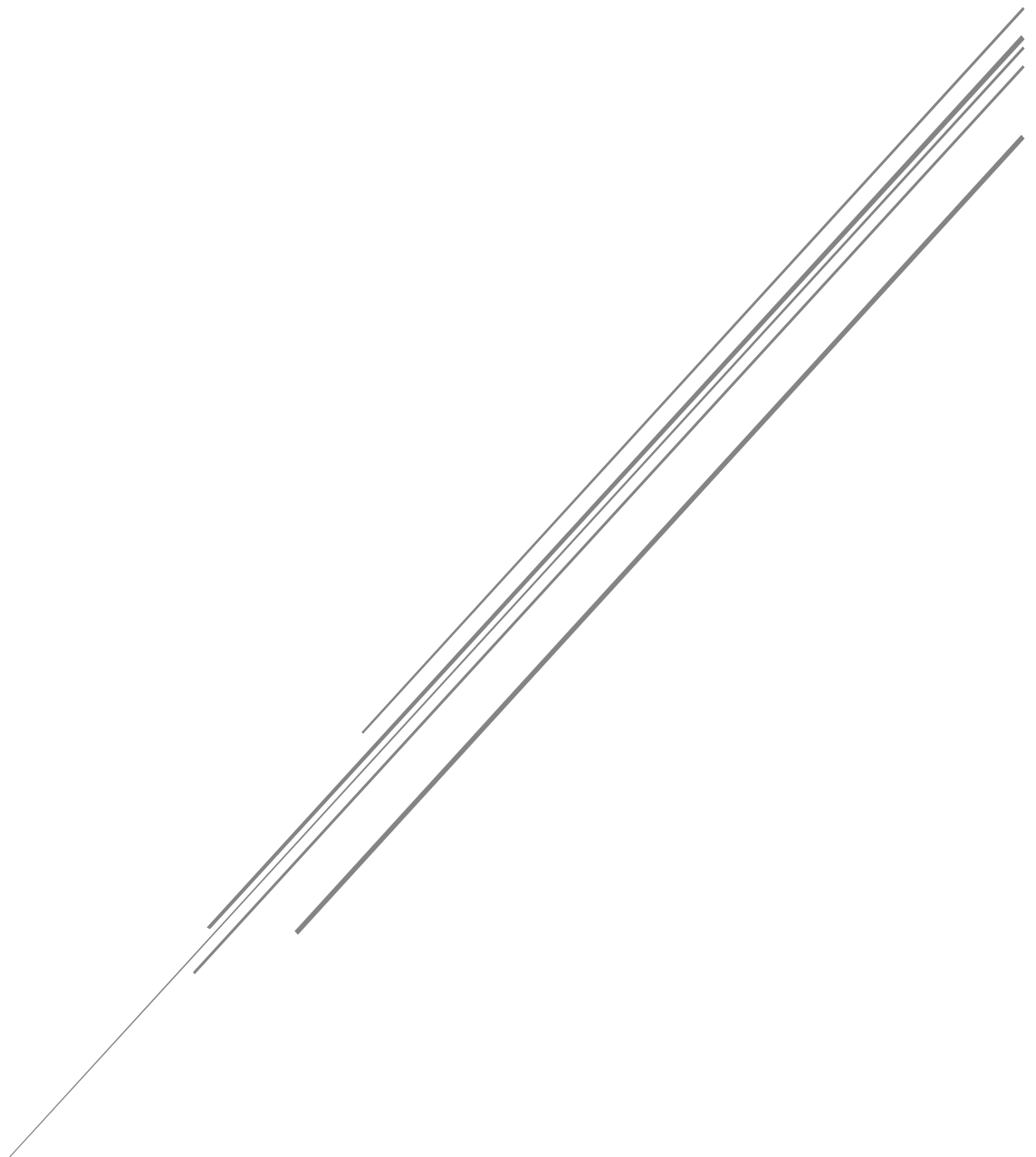


WATCHED

A Short film with Movie Poster made using Da Vinci
Resolve, Blender and The Adobe Suite.



South East Technological University Waterford
BSc (Hons) in Creative Computing

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Declaration of Authenticity

Except where explicitly stated, the report represents work that I have done myself. I have not submitted the work represented in this report in any other course of study leading to an academic award.

Abstract

The title '*Watched*' was chosen for this short film as it effectively captures the experience of living in a technology-driven, social media-saturated world. With the widespread use of public profiles, individuals are often observed by unknown audiences, raising questions about privacy and online visibility. The ambiguity of who is watching and their potential intentions creates an atmosphere of unease.

This short film explores the darker aspects of social media by showing the unsettling feeling of being constantly watched without truly knowing by whom. It aims to evoke the eerie sense that accompanies this digital surveillance, highlighting the potential risks of online exposure. The project also serves as an opportunity to experiment with an unfamiliar genre and utilize new technologies, fostering both creative and technical growth.

Overview

What is the purpose of the title?

'*Watched*' reflects the growing impact of social media and technology on everyday life, focusing on how normalized and overlooked the risks of sharing personal information online have become. What was once treated with caution and strict guidelines has now shifted into a culture of constant exposure, where privacy often takes a back seat to content creation. The concept of internet safety no longer carries the same weight, possibly because the digital world is expanding so rapidly that it becomes increasingly difficult to manage or regulate.

The film explores the unsettling reality that anyone, regardless of how active or visible they are online, can attract unwanted attention. It emphasizes that even individuals with small followings or those who post infrequently are not exempt from the possibility of being observed or targeted by strangers. This quiet, often unnoticed form of digital surveillance creates an eerie sense of vulnerability that the story aims to bring to life.

The short film fits within the thriller and mystery genres, offering a chance to experiment with new storytelling techniques and unfamiliar creative territory. In addition to the film itself, a promotional movie poster will be created as part of the project. This element provides an opportunity to incorporate photography and graphic design skills, helping to visually support and enhance the overall narrative.

What is the scope of the title?

The short film incorporates a range of digital tools to support both production and post-production, with a focus on editing, animation, and visual storytelling.

- **DaVinci Resolve** is used for video editing, colour grading, visual effects, and audio editing. As an industry-standard software, it plays a key role in shaping the overall tone and visual aesthetic of the final film.
- **Blender** serves as the primary tool for 3D animation. This open-source software is widely recognized for its versatility in creating visual effects, 3D models, and motion graphics. It is especially useful for producing animated elements such as title sequences and visual enhancements within the narrative.
- **Adobe InDesign** is used for creating the promotional film poster. With its strong layout and design capabilities, the software supports the development of high-quality marketing materials that visually represent the theme and tone of the short film.
- **Adobe After Effects** is utilized to create motion graphics and text animations. This includes animating text for title and ending sequences, as well as on-screen pop-ups of messages the protagonist receives, helping to visually convey key story elements.
- **Adobe Photoshop** is applied in image editing and graphic composition, supporting both the visual effects and design aspects of the film and its promotional content.
- **Flow Production Tracking** (*Formally- ShotGrid*) is used for version control and file management, providing a secure and organized environment for storing and tracking project assets throughout production.

The short film is expected to have a duration of approximately 5 to 10 minutes. This allows enough time to develop suspense and engage the audience, while maintaining a concise and impactful narrative. Animation is incorporated selectively, including animated logos of social media platforms and dynamic message pop-ups to enhance storytelling and visual appeal.

The protagonist's emotional arc follows a progression from confusion and indifference to fear and anxiety. As interactions with an anonymous online figure intensify, the tone shifts into a heightened sense of danger. This culminates in the character's decision to remove herself from social media, reflecting a breaking point in the narrative.

Both 2D and 3D animation are integrated into the project to support storytelling and demonstrate a range of technical skills. Typography animation is used in key sequences to emphasize messages and internal dialogue, and stylized on-screen animations are included to visually represent smartphone interactions in a more dynamic way than traditional filming methods.

Script, Story and Theme.

The story follows a young woman who is active on social media, frequently sharing moments from her daily life. She posts updates without considering that strangers may be watching or following her activities closely.

The tension begins to rise when an unfamiliar account repeatedly appears in her comment section. The comments start to include personal questions and observations that feel too specific to be random. At first, she ignores them, assuming it is just part of being online. However, after sharing a photo from a café with a tagged location, she receives a message from the account complimenting her hair. Looking around, she sees no one out of the ordinary, but the message feels too targeted. This incident triggers a sense of discomfort that lingers whenever she goes out in public.

Over time, the messages become more invasive, referencing things she has not posted about. As her anxiety increases, she begins to withdraw from social media. Her physical appearance begins to reflect her emotional state. She stops styling her hair, no longer wears makeup, and her clothing appears less put-together. Those around her begin to express concern.

Eventually, the stalking behaviour causes her to isolate herself. She stops attending college and work, seeking safety by staying inside. Although she tries to block the account, it keeps returning under different names. Reaching a breaking point, she chooses to delete all her social media accounts, cutting herself off from the online world to regain control and a sense of security.

This short film incorporates key storytelling techniques such as MacGuffin and Chekhov's Gun. The mobile phone functions as the MacGuffin. It is the primary object that connects the protagonist to social media and to the stranger who is following her. The phone's role is essential to the unfolding of events and becomes a source of tension each time it alerts her to new messages or notifications.

Chekhov's Gun is reflected in the character's excessive use of social media. This detail is not just part of the setting but plays a crucial role in the story's progression. Her constant online presence sets the stage for the conflict and leads to the eventual turning point, where she decides to disconnect entirely. The resolution gives this element a clear purpose and impact.

Foreshadowing was considered during the planning phase but ultimately not included. This story focuses more on emotional development and personal realization than on setting up a twist. The narrative builds through the protagonist's shifting mindset and her eventual decision to step away from social media, making a more straightforward approach to storytelling more effective.

Approach/Considerations

When approaching this project, I wanted to create something meaningful that reflected a current and relatable issue, specifically the increasing concerns around online safety and the dangers of social media. From the outset, my goal was to tell a story that was emotionally grounded with a strong message at its core. I aimed to raise awareness

without being overly instructional, allowing viewers to connect with the character and come to their own understanding of the risks involved in sharing personal information online.

A major consideration throughout the planning and development process was how to strike the right balance between narrative and message. I wanted the audience to feel engaged with the story and the character, not just informed. This shaped many of my creative decisions, including the structure of the film, the pacing, and the tone. I focused on creating an emotional journey for the protagonist that would mirror the gradual impact of her experience with the persistent and creepy messages she received, helping viewers relate to her experience.

Outside influences played a significant role in shaping the concept and direction of the film. I was particularly inspired by media that explores the darker side of technology and social media, such as *The Social Dilemma* and episodes of *Black Mirror*. These works showed how storytelling can be used to provoke reflection on real-world issues in a compelling and thought-provoking way. Real-life news stories about identity theft, cyberbullying, and the misuse of online data also influenced the project, reinforcing the relevance of the topic and motivating me to explore it in a narrative format.

I chose to develop this short film because the subject matter felt timely, important, and personally relevant. As someone who has grown up in the digital age, I have seen how quickly information can spread online and how unaware people often are of the long-term consequences. My intention was to create a film that not only entertains but also encourages viewers, particularly younger audiences, to think more critically about what they post, when they post it, and who might be watching. By presenting the story in a relatable and emotional way, I hoped to foster empathy and raise awareness about the importance of online safety.

User Experience

Audience Definition

The target audience is people who use social media. This is quite a broad audience which have many people of different backgrounds. We could have people who are very addicted to social media who posts everything about themselves and their life or someone who rarely uses it and is private online. Here are two examples:

- **Young Person, Social Media Addict:**
 - Description: The Young Person is an active social media user and posts about their life online and does not consider the dangers that come with using the social media. They also use social media to look at what other people are doing.

- Characteristics:
 - Social
 - Nosy
 - Dependent
- **Older person, rarely uses social media:**
 - Description: The Older Person is a rare user of social media, only opening Facebook once a week to keep in touch with family who live in New Zealand. They don't understand why young people share their whole lives online.
 - Characteristics:
 - Private
 - Independent
 - Reserved

Scenarios – typical user.

Young Person, Social Media Addict:

The younger person will find see the short film and will truly resonate with the story and message portrayed in the story. They may have experienced weird comments or interactions themselves and realise how unsafe it is for them to be posting about their life non-stop. They may put their accounts on private and block accounts that they are not familiar with.

The impact that the short film will have on the younger person will be that they will put all their social media profiles and that they will understand the message from the story that they shouldn't trust people online, even if they say they have good intentions.

Older Person, rarely uses social media:

The older person will already know that social media is dangerous as they have always warned their kids about stranger danger. The short film will give them a moment to realise just how extreme it has gotten over the years as technology has advanced. They would be concerned for young people as people online can easily hide their identity and trick others.

The impact that the short film has on the older person is that their fears for younger people only grow as the dangers of technology is brought more to their attention. They didn't realise just how much technology has grown and how easy it is to be someone who just floats under the radar rather than be easily identified. They are firmly in their

opinion that they are staying as far away from social media as possible other than to contact their family and friends that live around the world.

Feasibility Study

The feasibility study uses the TELOS method, which stands for Technology, Economic, Legal, Operational, and Schedule. This framework helps identify key considerations that may impact the project. By applying TELOS early in the planning process, potential challenges can be addressed in advance, allowing for a smoother and more efficient development phase.

Before the Execution of the Project

Technology

There are a lot of different technologies that I require for this project, both in software and for hardware. The software that I require for my project are all new to me, except for Adobe InDesign which is provided to me by the university. I will need to acquire DaVinci Resolve, Blender, and Pencil2D myself. In regard to hardware, I will need a camera and a tripod for my short film. I can borrow this equipment from the university.

Economic

For all of my required technology, I need to consider the cost and budget of my film. As a student, my budget is naturally very small and if I can avoid cost, I will. There is a free, standard version of DaVinci Resolve. This software has a paid version of \$295, which converts to around €275. I do not require the paid version so I can avoid expenditure here. Both Blender and Pencil2D are free, open-source software so I also avoid expenditure here too.

Legal

The current legislation for copyright protection in the EU and Ireland is the Copyright and Related Rights Act 2000. It ensures the protection of work and media such as books, songs, films and plays. It also protects the author of the media mentioned above. To avoid copyright infringement, I will ensure that any images, music and sound effects used in my short film are copyright free and open to use for the wider community to avoid legal issues. To use the names of social media platforms and their likeness, I will have to make sure that I follow their Fair Use Policy to ensure that I keep true to their brand and not use my platform to tarnish theirs.

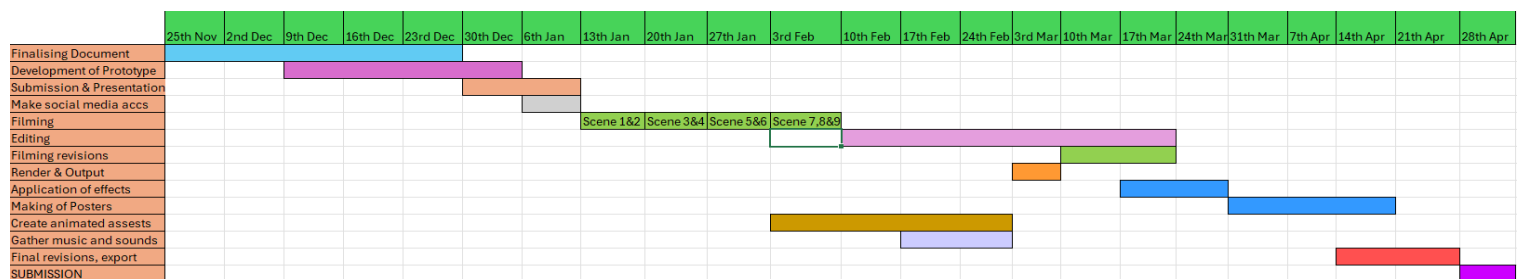
Operational

The purpose of this short film is to show the importance of protecting yourself online and how dangerous social media truly is. When the audience watches this short film, I want them to see themselves in the main character and feel the same emotions as she

does as time passes in the duration of the short film. I would like this short film to encourage people to practice online safety and be more aware of what they post and when and where they post it too.

Scheduling

For this project and to ensure that it is completed on time, I would use a Gantt chart to schedule myself. This method has been taught to me in one of my modules and I find this methodology extremely useful and helpful. A Gantt chart is a horizontal bar chart used to visually show the timeframe of a project. This schedule will be very heavy in terms of workload at typically, these projects will have a team where there will be different people managing various aspects of the project, for example, there would be a filming crew and an editing crew. For this project, it is strictly a solo project where I will be managing all sections of the project. This is also an important reason as why there is a Gantt Chart included in this document to plan out the project schedule and make sure I meet the deadlines for each section of the project.



After the Execution of the Project

Technology

For my project, I used most of the technology that I initially planned to use. I did not use Pencil2D as I chose that I did not want to include 2D animation through that software and instead chose to use Adobe After Effects to make the text messages on the screen. I chose to use Adobe Illustrator instead of Adobe InDesign for my movie poster as I prefer the interface of that software a lot more.

Economic

The only purchase that I had to make for the production of this short film was my tripod. I bought it off of Amazon for only €16. All my software were open-source and free to use or already paid for by the university, such as the Adobe licencing.

Legal

The legislation governing copyright protection in the EU and Ireland includes the Copyright and Related Rights Act 2000, as amended, along with more recent updates such as the EU Copyright Directive (Directive 2019/790), which strengthens the protection of digital content. These laws safeguard creative works like books, music, films, and plays, and protect the rights of their authors. To avoid copyright infringement

in my short film, I ensure that all images, music, and sound effects are either copyright-free, licensed for open use, or used with proper permission. Additionally, when referencing social media platforms and their branding, I follow their Fair Use policies and brand guidelines to respect their intellectual property and avoid any misrepresentation or legal issues.

Operational

When I finish the short film, I share it with peers to gather feedback and see how they connect with it. The purpose of the film is to show the importance of protecting yourself online and to highlight how dangerous social media can be. As people watch the film, I want them to see themselves in the main character and experience the emotions she goes through as time passes. I hope this short film encourages viewers to practice better online safety and to think more carefully about what they post, when they post it, and where they share it.

Scheduling

For this project, I use a Gantt chart to schedule and manage my time effectively. This method was taught to me in one of my modules, and I find it extremely useful for planning and staying on track. Normally, projects like this would involve a team with different people managing filming, editing, and other tasks, but since this is a solo project, I am responsible for all aspects. Because of this, having a Gantt chart in place is essential for meeting deadlines and managing the workload. Alongside the Gantt chart, I also use Notion to create weekly task lists. This combination helps me keep track of where I leave off each week and ensures I consistently move toward my progress goals. Although the 12 weeks initially feel like a long stretch, the time flies by, and having these tools helps me stay organized and stick to my schedule for the majority of the project.

Methodology

The Problem from a Process Viewpoint.

Film Production Pipeline is a more linear process for making a short film. It follows three main steps, Pre-Production, Production, and Post-Production. This makes the process feel more organized and clearer in the mind when knowing what steps to take next. Pre-production involves writing your script, drawing your storyboards, completing your animatics, making your call sheets. You will also assign your cast, make props, design your costumes, hair, makeup and set locations. In the Production phase, you capture your footage which will reflect your script and your animatic. The editing process will also take place in this phase but also blend into the next phase which is post-production. Post-production is when you finalise the edits and add any of the required effects and animations. There should also be a trailer released during this stage so the

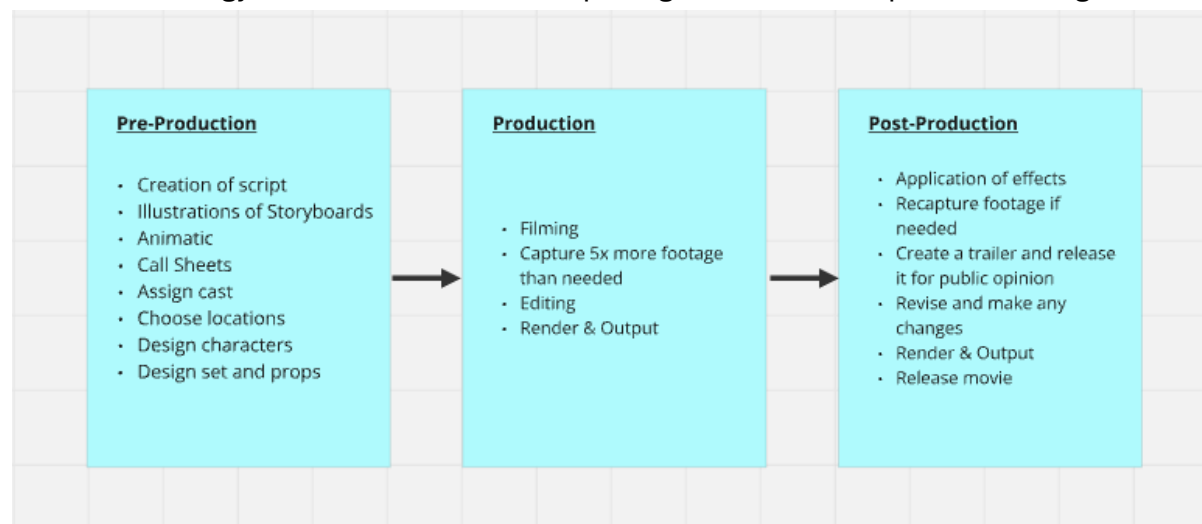
producers can get some feedback from the viewers so they can make any final changes beforehand.

Reverse Engineering is when you learn how you want the final product to look first and then developing the steps to get to your goal of the final product. This tactic is sometimes more difficult to do, specifically in group projects as not everyone will have the same, concise idea if it's not written on paper. This tactic will often be compared to the film production pipeline, but it will start backwards of the typical format. In Reverse Engineering, the film can be recorded before a script is even written and just base the film on strictly improv. Unlike the Production Pipeline, where you have steps with certain tasks allocated to them, you can do the filming and editing before you even do the storyboards and script.

Assessment of Chosen Methodology

The methodology that I have chosen is the Film Production Pipeline. I have studied this methodology many times over the last three years and also used it in my internship semester. This methodology will work for my project as it will help to outline each and every movement and moment in the short film and make it easier when filming and editing.

The film production pipeline is widely used all over the world, in some of the most world-renowned film-making companies such as Disney and Warner Brothers. I think this methodology is the best choice to help me get even more experience using it.



Aftermath of Chosen Methodology

Reflecting on the project, using the Film Production Pipeline proved to be the right decision. Following the clear structure of Pre-Production, Production, and Post-Production made the process more manageable and helped me stay organized throughout. Pre-Production work, like scripting, storyboarding, and planning, created a strong foundation that made filming more efficient and reduced stress during Production. Editing naturally overlapped into post-production.

Looking back, I believe that if I had used a Reverse Engineering approach, the project would have been much harder to control. Without a detailed plan, it would have been easy to lose focus, especially when working alone. The Film Production Pipeline gave me a clear roadmap to follow and made the workload feel more structured.

Overall, the methodology I chose not only helped me complete the project successfully but also gave me valuable experience applying industry-standard practices. I feel much more confident now in managing future projects independently.

Management of the process

As this project was entirely a solo development effort, it was important to establish an organized and consistent method for planning and tracking each stage of progress. At the beginning of the semester, I created a Gantt chart to map out an ideal timeline for the twelve weeks allocated to the project. This visual schedule helped me set realistic milestones and ensure that I remained on track. The chart can be found in the Feasibility Study, under the 'Scheduling' section. Alongside this, I used Notion to manage my ongoing progress in a more dynamic and flexible way. Notion is a digital workspace that brings together note-taking, task management, and project organization into one platform. It supports a range of features such as customizable databases, to-do lists, calendars, and page linking, which allowed me to structure my workflow effectively. I created a dedicated page for this project where I set weekly goals, tracked completed and pending tasks, and made notes about any changes or delays.

In addition to Notion, I also used Flow Production Tracking to manage the more granular details of the production process. This tool was particularly useful for keeping track of individual shots, noting their completion status, and recording whether reshoots or edits were required. It provided a clear visual overview of what had been filmed, what was in post-production, and what still needed to be done. This was especially helpful when working on the animated title sequence, which involved multiple steps—from conceptualization and design to final rendering. By breaking the sequence into smaller components within Flow, I was able to assign statuses and deadlines to each task, which helped me stay focused and prioritize efficiently. The combination of Flow Production Tracking for shot-level detail and Notion for broader project management ensured that both the creative and logistical aspects of the project were aligned and under control throughout development.

Risk Management

Throughout the duration of the project, I encountered only a few significant issues, all of which were manageable with some adjustment. One of the main setbacks was losing access to Flow Production Tracking for about a month due to the university's license

expiring. This temporarily disrupted how I tracked production stages, but I was able to adapt by relying more heavily on Notion during that period. Another challenge arose during the filming of the first scene. The original location proved problematic due to excessive background noise that interfered with the audio quality. As a result, we had to reschedule and relocate to a quieter setting, which delayed progress slightly but ultimately improved the final result. Additionally, I experienced a technical issue when the files for Scene Eight were lost and unrecoverable. This required me to reshoot the entire scene, which was unexpected but manageable thanks to proper planning and scheduling buffers. Fortunately, these were the only major issues I faced, and none of them had a lasting negative impact on the overall timeline or quality of the project.

Tools and Technologies

Hardware

- **Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra** – This device will be used to film the movie.



- **Sony WH-CH720N headphones** - Used in the editing process for good audio quality.



- **PCSpecialist Custom Built PC**

Processor (CPU)	AMD Ryzen 5 5500GT Six Core CPU with Radeon Graphics (3.6GHz/19MB Cache/AM4)
Motherboard	ASUS TUF Gaming B550-PLUS (AM4, DDR4, PCIe 4.0)
Memory (RAM)	16GB PCS PRO DDR4 3200MHz (1 x 16GB)
1 st M.2 SSD Drive	512GB PCS PCIe M.2 SSD (3500 MB/R, 3100 MB/W)
2 nd M.2 SSD Drive	2TB Seagate Barracuda SATA-III 3.5" HDD, 6GB/s, 7200RPM, 256MB Cache
Operating System	Windows 11 Home 64 Bit – inc. Single Licence

Software

- **Storyboard.That**– Used to create storyboards.
- **DaVinci Resolve 19** – Used to edit the short film.
- **Blender 4.1**– To create 3D shapes and animations.
- **Adobe Illustrator 20.0.1** – Creating Movie poster and advertisements.
- **Adobe After Effects 25.0** – Editing and adding effects.
- **Flow Production Tracking** – Version Control.

Project Evaluation

During the process of creating and developing this project, I had multiple opportunities to reflect on the decisions and steps taken throughout the production. One of the most significant challenges I encountered was the limited access to adequate resources while on campus. Due to the scheduling of other modules and classes, I spent around 22 hours per week on campus, with approximately 6 to 7 of those hours falling outside of class time. I had initially hoped to use those gaps productively, but technical limitations prevented that. My personal laptop did not have the necessary processing power to run the full range of software required for the project, such as editing and animation tools. Additionally, the on-campus facilities were unreliable, with either the equipment not being functional, or the network connection was so poor that even loading a basic web browser became difficult at times. This lack of access significantly restricted my ability to use downtime effectively, ultimately tightening the window I had to work on the project overall.

As I mentioned earlier, there was also a setback involving Flow Production Tracking. I lost access to the software for about a month due to the university's licensing lapse. This created an additional hurdle, as I had been relying on the platform to monitor progress on individual scenes and elements, including the animated title sequence. Without it, I had to shift some of my workflow to Notion temporarily, which, while helpful, didn't offer the same level of detail or tracking specificity. Thankfully, access was eventually restored, and I was able to resume using the software to stay organized and on schedule.

Despite these challenges, I am proud of the overall development of my project. I feel that I made the most of the time and resources available to me, adapting when necessary and staying consistent with my goals. That said, if I had been granted an additional month to work on the project, there are a few areas I would improve—most notably, the quality of the animated title sequence. Animation proved to be one of the more challenging aspects for me, and with more time, I would have liked to refine the sequence further, focusing on smoother motion, better timing, and overall polish. Nonetheless, the experience taught me valuable lessons about time management, adapting to setbacks, and maximizing the tools I had access to at any given time.

Testing

Once I completed the short film, I carried out a round of informal user testing by sharing it with a group of peers and asking for their feedback. This was a crucial step, as it allowed me to gauge how effectively the narrative, tone, and message resonated with the intended audience. The primary goal of the film is to emphasize the importance of online safety and raise awareness about the risks associated with social media. I wanted viewers to connect emotionally with the main character, seeing aspects of themselves in her journey and understanding the gradual consequences of oversharing online. Through this testing process, I was able to observe audience reactions in real-time and gather their thoughts on both the storytelling and technical aspects of the film.

I encouraged participants to reflect on how the film made them feel, what they took away from it, and whether the message about online safety came through clearly. I also asked specific questions about the pacing, clarity of the narrative, emotional impact, and effectiveness of the animated title sequence. Many viewers commented that the film felt relatable and that it made them reconsider the way they use social media, which was a strong indication that the core message had landed successfully. Others offered constructive criticism, particularly around moments where the audio could have been clearer or where transitions between scenes could be smoothed out. Some suggested that the emotional arc of the character could be deepened with more visual cues or subtle performance adjustments.

This feedback was incredibly valuable in evaluating the success of the project from an audience engagement perspective. It helped me identify both the strengths and areas for improvement in the final cut. If I had more time, I would have liked to incorporate some of the suggestions—such as refining audio levels or enhancing emotional beats visually—to further strengthen the overall impact. Nonetheless, the testing confirmed that the film effectively prompted viewers to think more critically about what they post online, when they post it, and the potential consequences of their digital footprint, which was the ultimate objective of the piece.

Demo

<https://youtu.be/fz38p-T5BnE>

ShotGrid Login:

Email: 20097677@mail.wit.ie

Password: FinalYear2025

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Appendices

Script

Scene One

The scene opens in a cozy, bustling café. The ambient noise of chatter, clinking cups, and a soft background playlist sets the tone. Claire, the main character, sits at a small wooden table by the window, her coffee steaming gently in front of her.

The first shot is over Claire's shoulder, focusing on her phone screen as she taps to post a photo of her coffee with a location tag on Instagram. The camera lingers briefly on the screen, showing the caption and the tag before switching to a wide shot of Claire and her friend Marie sitting across from her.

Claire:

*How have you been?

Marie:

*I've been good! How about you? And how was your trip to Dublin?

Claire:

(pausing slightly) Oh! How did you know I was in Dublin?

Marie:

(grinning) Well, you were posting nonstop on Instagram about it. How could I not know?

Claire:

(laughing nervously) Oh... right. I didn't realize you'd seen my posts.

She takes a sip of her coffee, her expression shifting slightly, a mix of surprise and reflection.

The camera focuses on Claire's face, subtly showing her processing the idea of how much Marie already knew about her life from social media.

The next shot transitions to a scenic exterior view through the café's large windows. The soft hum of the café's chatter continues as the camera captures the golden glow of the street outside, dotted with pedestrians and passing cars.

Scene Two

The scene opens in a bright college classroom. Claire sits at her desk near the window, her phone in hand.

The first shot is from Claire's perspective, showing her posting a new update on social media. The screen reveals her location: a college class in a specific building at 9:15 AM. Her fingers move quickly as she types the caption and hits "post." She places her phone face up on the desk, the screen dimming but still active.

The camera cuts to a close-up of the phone. Suddenly, a notification banner slides down: "[@user101202] has started following you." The screen remains in focus as more notifications rapidly follow—likes on Claire's posts flood in, one after another. A subtle animation emphasizes the growing list of interactions, the pace becoming increasingly frantic.

Claire:

(whispering to herself, barely audible) What the hell?

She glances around to see if anyone else has noticed her reaction. When no one seems to be paying attention, Claire hurriedly picks up her phone and silences it, her expression a mixture of confusion and slight unease.

The final shot lingers on the phone as it vibrates on the desk, the screen lighting up with relentless notifications from the same strange account. The sound of the lecturer's

voice begins in the background, juxtaposing the calm of the class with Claire's growing apprehension.

Scene Three

The scene opens in Claire's cozy bedroom, softly lit by the warm afternoon sun streaming through partially open curtains. The room is slightly cluttered, with clothes and books scattered around, hinting at her recent busy schedule.

Claire sits cross-legged on her bed, holding her phone. The screen shows her editing a selfie—a polished photo from two days ago, her hair styled perfectly, and makeup expertly done. She types a light-hearted caption, hits "post," and places her phone face down on her nightstand. With a small sigh, she stands and begins tidying up her room, humming a soft tune from a musical.

The calm is broken by the sharp buzz of notifications from her phone. At first, Claire ignores it, assuming it's the usual likes and comments. But as the buzzing continues, rapid and insistent, her curiosity grows. She pauses, brushes a strand of hair from her face, and grabs her phone.

The next shot focuses on the phone screen as Claire scrolls through her notifications. They're all from the same account that followed her a day earlier.

(Comments from @user101202):

- *Your hair is so beautiful!*
- *What eye shadow do you use?*
- *That shirt looks really good with your complexion!*

The camera cuts to a close-up of Claire's face, illuminated by the bluish glow of her phone screen. Her brow furrows slightly, her lips pressing into a thin line as she processes the strange, overly familiar compliments.

She taps on the username to open the account. The screen reveals a blank profile: no posts, no profile picture, and no other identifying details. Claire's thumb hesitates for a moment, then she shrugs, dismissing the thought as unimportant. She locks her phone with a soft click and tosses it back onto the bed.

Returning to her cleaning, Claire resumes humming her tune, her demeanour lightening again as the unsettling moment fades into the background. The camera pans out, showing her tidying up while the phone rests silently on the bed.

Scene Four

The scene begins with a soft evening glow filling Claire's room. She's curled up on her desk chair with a blanket draped over her legs, sipping a cup of tea. The low hum of a TV

show plays in the background on her computer monitor, but Claire's focus is on her phone.

The first shot is over Claire's shoulder, showing her phone screen as she posts a casual photo on her Instagram story: a picture of her tea and a cozy corner of the room, captioned, "Perfect end to a long day." The image posts, and Claire sets her phone down on her desk, leaning back with a small smile of satisfaction.

Moments later, her phone buzzes. She picks it up and sees a new notification: a direct message reply to her story from the same strange account, @user101202. The next shot focuses on the screen as Claire opens her DMs. A string of messages appears, sent in quick succession:

@user101202:

- *That tea looks amazing! What kind is it?*
- *Your space is so cozy. Wish I was there!*
- *You have such a good vibe in your photos.*

Claire's expression shifts, her smile fading. A close-up shows her finger hovering over the screen as if considering how to respond, but she hesitates. She scrolls up briefly, revealing a list of other unanswered messages from the same account, sent over the past few days. They're innocuous but strangely persistent:

@user101202:

- *Hope you're having a good day!*
- *What a lovely picture, where was it taken?*
- *You looked so happy in your last post!*

Claire exhales sharply, her unease growing. She locks the phone without replying and places it face down on the table. Crossing her arms, she leans back into her chair, her eyes drifting to the computer screen, though her focus isn't on the show anymore. The camera lingers on the phone, the glow of another notification lighting up its darkened screen. Claire pointedly ignores it, pulling the blanket tighter around herself as if to create a barrier between her and the unsettling messages. The final shot, leaving Claire in the frame, a small figure in her cozy but now slightly disquieting space.

Scene Five

The scene opens with a lively atmosphere in a bustling park. The sound of birds chirping and distant chatter blends with the rustle of leaves in the breeze. Claire sits on a bench near a fountain, enjoying the afternoon sun. She takes out her phone and snaps a quick photo of the scene in front of her: the fountain and the pretty weather. The shot captures the moment perfectly. The camera follows Claire's actions as she posts the photo to her Instagram story with the caption: "*Love this spot—needed some fresh air.*" She smiles

to herself and slips the phone into her jacket pocket before turning to sip her coffee, her focus now on people-watching.

Moments later, her phone buzzes. Claire sighs, pulling it out again, expecting a generic like or comment. Her face stiffens as she reads the latest direct message from the strange account, @user101202:

@user101202:

- *You look stunning today. That jacket suits you so well!*

Claire frowns, her brows furrowing. She scrolls up through the earlier DMs from the account, her unease growing as she notices a pattern:

@user101202:

- *Your hair looks so soft today.*
- *I love the colour of your nails—it's so you!*
- *That smile of yours is everything.*

The unsettling part? Claire hasn't posted anything about her appearance in days. She clicks back to the user's profile: still no posts, no bio, no profile picture. Just the same blank account following only a handful of people, including her.

The camera captures a close-up of Claire's face, her unease clearly etched as she locks her phone and stuffs it back into her pocket. She glances around the park nervously, her eyes scanning the crowd. Her fingers tighten around her coffee as she takes a calming sip, trying to shake off the creeping discomfort.

The next shot is from Claire's perspective as she looks at her reflection in the fountain water, suddenly self-conscious. Her posture stiffens slightly, and her earlier carefree mood is now replaced with a subtle tension.

The final shot shows Claire walking away from the bench, her phone still buzzing faintly in her pocket. She keeps her head down, clutching her bag a little tighter, as the vibrant park scene around her contrasts with her growing sense of unease.

Scene Six

The scene opens in Claire's bedroom, now dimly lit by the soft grey light of a cloudy morning. The once-tidy space is now cluttered—a stark contrast to her earlier posts showcasing an organized and cozy vibe. Clothes are draped over a chair, a couple of empty coffee mugs sit on her nightstand, and her bed is unmade.

Claire sits at her desk in a loose hoodie and sweatpants, her hair pulled back into a messy bun. Her makeup-free face looks tired, dark circles under her eyes hinting at restless nights. The camera lingers on her as she stares at her phone, scrolling absentmindedly through social media, but not engaging.

The first shot focuses on her hand hovering over the Instagram app. She hesitates for a moment, her finger trembling slightly before she opens it. Her profile appears—photos of happy moments and carefully curated posts that now feel like a distant memory. She sighs softly and closes the app without posting anything.

The next shot shows her phone screen lighting up with a notification: another DM from the strange account, @user101202. The camera captures the glow reflecting off Claire's face as she reads the message, her lips pressing into a tight line.

@user101202:

- *Miss seeing your beautiful posts. Are you okay? You're still so gorgeous, even if you're not showing it off anymore.*

Claire's expression hardens, a mix of frustration and exhaustion. She locks her phone and tosses it onto the desk, leaning back in her chair and rubbing her temples. Her gaze drifts to the mirror on her shelf, where she catches a glimpse of her dishevelled appearance. She looks at herself for a moment, her eyes dull, before turning away.

The camera transitions to Claire sitting cross-legged on her bed, scrolling on her laptop instead. Her posture is slouched, and the bright, confident energy she once exuded is noticeably absent. A soft chime signals another notification from her phone, but she pointedly ignores it, burying herself deeper in her blanket.

The final shot zooms out, capturing the sombre atmosphere of the room. The warm, lively colours from earlier scenes are now muted, mirroring Claire's fading enthusiasm and the toll the strange interactions have taken on her. The sound of the phone buzzing faintly in the background lingers as the scene fades to black.

Scene Seven

The scene opens with a quiet shot of Claire's apartment from the outside. A gentle rain taps against the glass, amplifying the sense of isolation.

Inside, Claire lies curled up on her bed, wrapped in a thick blanket. Her room is dim, lit only by the glow of her phone screen and the faint grey light filtering through the curtains. The clutter has grown; an untouched mug of tea sits on her nightstand, now cold. Claire's face is pale, her expression blank as she stares at her phone.

The camera shifts to a close-up of her phone screen. Messages from Marie fill the screen, each one unanswered:

Marie:

- *Hey, haven't heard from you in a while. Are you okay?*
- *Claire, I'm worried. Please let me know you're alright.*
 - *Do you want to grab coffee later? My treat!*
- *Claire?*

Claire's thumb hovers over the screen, as though considering typing a reply, but she sighs and locks the phone instead. Tossing it onto the other side of the bed, she buries her face in the pillow, her shoulders rising and falling with a shaky breath.

The camera cuts to a wider shot of the room. Claire's once-vibrant personality is absent in the muted tones and cluttered space. Her laptop sits closed on the desk, untouched. The sound of the rain grows louder, filling the heavy silence.

In the next shot, Claire sits up slightly, gazing toward the window. Her eyes are tired, and she looks apprehensive. The thought of leaving the house, of being seen, clearly weighs on her. She pulls the blanket tighter around herself and lies back down, turning away from the light filtering through the curtains.

The camera transitions to a close-up of her phone vibrating faintly on the bed. Another message from Marie pops up on the lock screen, but Claire doesn't even glance at it.

Marie (on screen):

- *I'm here for you, Claire. Please talk to me when you're ready.*

The scene ends with Claire curled up in the foetal position, her face partially hidden by the blanket. The sound of rain continues, leaving her small and isolated in the frame.

Scene Eight

The scene opens with the dim glow of Claire's phone illuminating her face in the quiet of the evening. She's seated at her desk, the room around her still and empty. The only sound is the faint hum of the phone as it vibrates with a new notification—a message from Marie, once again.

Marie (on screen):

- *Please, Claire. I miss you. I'm worried. Can we talk?*

Claire's thumb hovers over the message for a moment, then she pulls it away. Her fingers tremble slightly as she locks the phone and sets it aside. Her face is unreadable, her gaze distant, lost in thought. The camera lingers on her as she exhales, a deep, heavy breath, as if she's finally come to a decision.

The next shot shows Claire opening the Instagram app. Her profile appears on the screen—her posts, her stories, the highlights of her life on display. She scrolls through her feed slowly, pausing at each photo: the joyful moments, the carefully curated images, the life she used to share with the world. Her finger hesitates over the “Delete Account” option, but her eyes are empty.

The camera cuts to a close-up of Claire's face, lit by the cool light of the screen. There's a sense of finality in her expression, a weight to the decision. She clicks on the option.

The next shot shows the phone screen confirming the action: “Are you sure you want to permanently delete your account?”

Claire's finger hovers over the “Confirm” button, and for a moment, time seems to stretch. She closes her eyes, almost as if bracing for the end of an era. The camera lingers on her hand, her finger slowly pressing down, and then the screen flashes: “Your account has been deleted.”

The final shot is of Claire sitting in silence, staring at the empty phone screen. The weight of the decision hangs in the air. The camera pulls back, revealing the emptiness of the room around her—the absence of the digital world that once defined her. She places the phone face down on the desk, and without another word, she walks away from the desk, leaving the phone behind. The camera slowly zooms in on the now-blank screen, the silence growing louder.

The screen fades to black, the quiet lingering.

Scene Nine

The scene opens with soft morning light spilling into Claire's bedroom. The room feels fresh and inviting, with a tidy, cozy ambiance. A warm glow fills the space, accentuated by the scent of a scented candle lingering in the air. There's a sense of peace and renewal—Claire's space now reflects her inner transformation.

Claire stands in front of her mirror, smiling at her reflection. She's wearing brightly coloured clothes, something fun and bold that contrasts with the muted tones of earlier scenes. The camera captures the small, intentional moments of self-care: brushing her hair, applying a touch of makeup with a steady hand, and adjusting the collar of her shirt, all with a relaxed, confident expression.

She takes a moment to step back and admire her reflection, a contented smile playing on her lips. She adjusts her hair to fall gently around her face, looking at herself in the mirror and laughing softly. The camera lingers on her face, capturing the joy and ease she now carries with her.

The camera transitions to Claire walking confidently around her room, tidying up a few things as she goes. There's an energy about her now, lively and unburdened. She pauses by the window, looking outside at the bright day ahead.

Claire then grabs her jacket from the bed, slipping it on with a final glance at her room—now organized, calm, and full of light. She pulls open the door and steps out of her bedroom, her movements purposeful and filled with a newfound sense of freedom and joy.

The final shot shows Claire walking out the front door, stepping into the day with a smile that says she's ready for whatever comes next. Her confidence and happiness radiate as she steps out into the world, no longer held back by doubt.

The scene fades out as Claire continues walking, a figure full of life and promise, the sounds of the outside world growing clearer as she moves forward.

Storyboards

Scene 1



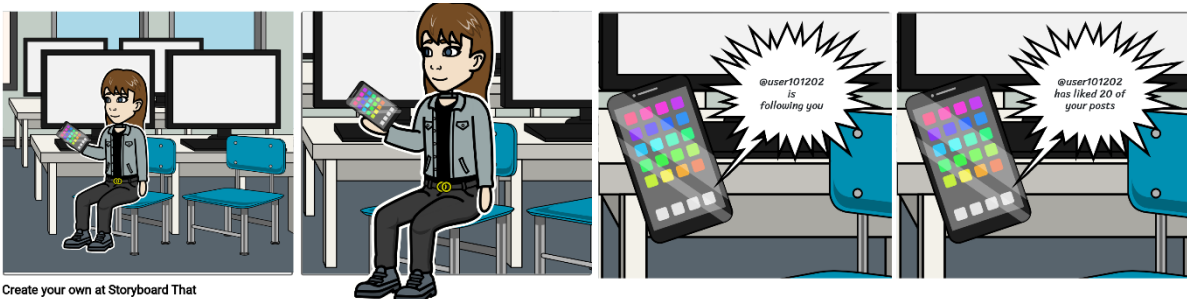
Create your own at [Storyboard That](#)

Shot One: Still shot with both characters on screen. Still camera. They say their respective dialogue. There is background noise of the bustling café.

Shot Two: Close up of Clare's expression as she sips coffee. Still camera. There is still background noise of the café.

Shot Three: Scenic shot of the café. Panning. Natural background sounds.

Scene 2



Create your own at [Storyboard That](#)

Shot One: Wide still shot. Shows main character on her phone. Natural light and background sounds.

Shot Two: Closer shot of the main character. Still. Natural light and background sounds.

Shot Three: Close up of phone, pop up on screen of notification. Still camera. Sound of phone vibrations.

Scene 3



Create your own at Storyboard That

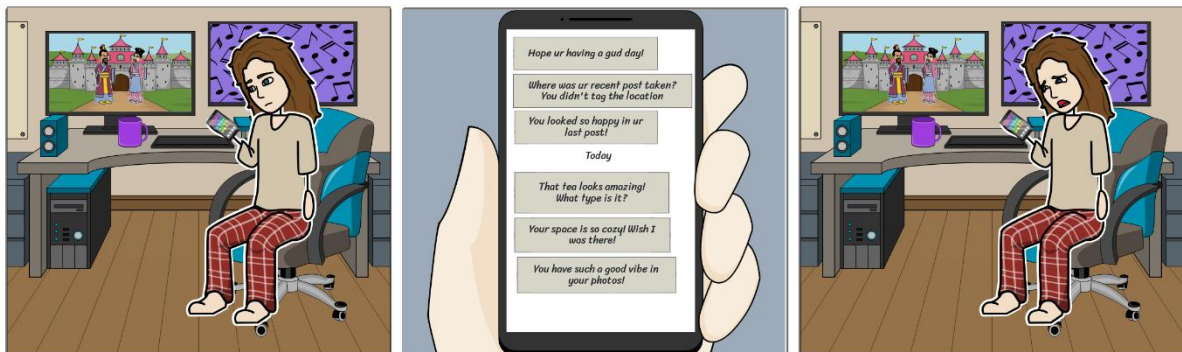
Shot One: Wide shot of Bedroom, panning to show the slight dishevelment of her room from her busy lifestyle. Main character is on her phone, sitting on her bed.

Shot Two: Shot of her phone on her desk. Still camera.

Shot Three: Sound of phone vibrations. Still Camera. Pop-up notification of the messages.

Shot Four: Close up shot of the main character looking uncomfortable while reading the notifications.

Scene 4



Create your own at Storyboard That

Shot One: Still shot of the main character sitting at her desk. She posts something on social media, a pop-up of what she posts shows on screen. Background noise of tv show playing on her computer.

Shot Two: Pop-up of the weird messages she receives from the stranger. Background noise of tv show playing on her computer.

Shot Three: Shot of main character looking stressed while reading the messages. Background noise of tv show playing on her computer.

Scene 5



Create your own at Storyboard That

Shot One: Main Character sitting on a bench in the park. The sound of nature and kids playing can be heard. She posts a photo of the fountain on her social media. Still Camera.

Shot Two: Pop-up of the weird messages she receives from the stranger.

Shot Three: Close up shot of the worried look on the main characters face. Still camera shot. Background noise is the same as shot one.

Scene 6



Create your own at Storyboard That

Shot One: Main character in bed. Her room is dishevelled, and the room is silent. It is clear that she is not doing well. Her phone vibrates and she tries to ignore the sound.

Shot Two: Main character gets out of bed to look at her mobile phone. Camera still.

Shot Three: Pop-up of the messages from the account. Natural light and background sounds.

Shot Four: Main character sat on her bed scrolling through her laptop as her phone distantly chimes in the background. Camera still and then pans over the room, showing it becoming dishevelled.

Scene 7



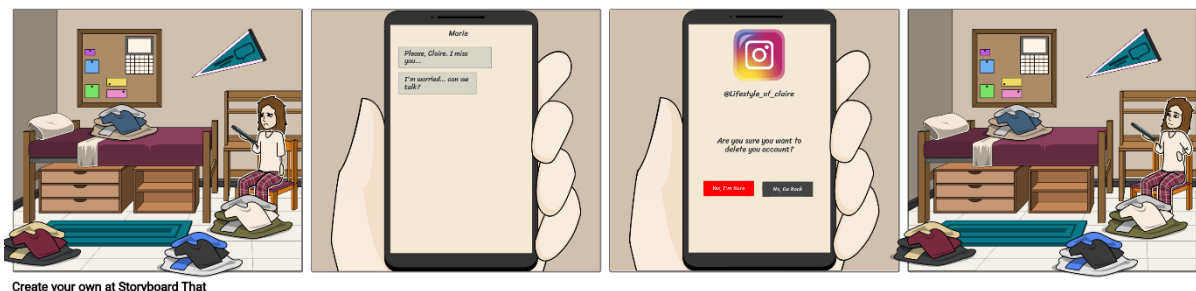
Shot One: Main Character is in bed, scrolling on her phone, looking sad and upset. The camera is still, no dialogue and just natural light and background sounds.

Shot Two: Pop-up of messages from Marie to the Main character, asking about her wellbeing. Natural light and background sounds, still camera.

Shot Three: Main Character puts her phone at the other end of the bed, ignoring messages. Still camera. Natural light and background sounds.

Shot Four: Close up of phone as it vibrates more and more with messages. Still camera, phone vibration sounds and natural light and background sounds.

Scene 8



Shot One: Main Character sitting at her desk on her phone. Still camera. Natural light and background sounds.

Shot Two: Messages from Marie pop-up on screen. Phone vibration noise.

Shot Three: Screen showing main character deleting her social media accounts.

Shot Four: Main character looking relieved and calm. Natural light and background sounds.

Scene 9



Create your own at Storyboard That

Shot One: Main character looks like she is in a much better place than before. The camera shot is wider, and her bedroom is clean and tidy. She applies some beauty products. Natural light and background sounds.

Shot Two: Main character is ready to leave the house. Her attitude is brighter. Natural light and background sounds.

Shot Three: Main character outside and ready to start fresh. The weather is brighter and reflects her mood. Natural light and background sounds.